

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING**

Complaint

United States District Court for the Eastern District of North Carolina

Rhea Calder v. Cinder Lake Health Network, Inc.

Civil Action No. SYN-EDNC-25-CV-0882

Docket Entry 1 — Filed December 3, 2025

Plaintiff Rhea Calder alleges retaliation under 31 U.S.C. § 3730(h). Cinder Lake Health Network, Inc. is a fictional North Carolina health-services organization. Calder alleges that she investigated and reported suspected federal-program billing irregularities while employed in Cinder Lake's compliance department, and that Cinder Lake later terminated her because of protected efforts to stop potential violations.

This complaint states allegations, not findings. It does not assert a claim for disclosure of privileged communications, seek counsel's legal advice, or make any conclusion about the merits of Calder's reports.

Parties

Calder is a fictional former compliance analyst who worked from Cinder Lake's Raleigh administrative office. Her responsibilities included comparing internal billing exception reports with source records and escalating discrepancies through designated compliance channels. She alleges that her work brought her into contact with employees responsible for federal-program submissions.

Cinder Lake is alleged to operate fictional outpatient facilities in the Eastern District of North Carolina and to participate in federal health-benefit programs. Calder alleges that the organization employed her and made the challenged employment decisions in this district. No real patient, claim, provider, facility, or program account appears in this record.

Jurisdiction and Venue

The Court has federal-question jurisdiction under 28 U.S.C. § 1331 because Calder invokes the retaliation remedy in 31 U.S.C. § 3730(h). She seeks relief for alleged employment retaliation, not adjudication of a government enforcement claim. Venue is alleged to be proper because the relevant employment and reporting events occurred in the Eastern District of North Carolina.

Calder demands a jury on issues triable by jury. She does not contend at this pleading stage that every communication made during Cinder Lake's later internal investigation is discoverable. Discovery scope, privilege, work product, and any waiver question remain for later process.

Protected-Activity Allegations

Beginning in May 2025, Calder allegedly identified recurring mismatches between selected federal-program billing summaries and supporting service documentation. She states that she preserved ordinary business records and raised the mismatches through her supervisor and the compliance intake channel. The complaint describes categories only and omits any operational billing method or patient information.

Calder alleges that she reasonably believed the discrepancies warranted investigation and that her reports were intended to stop submission or retention of inaccurate claims. Cinder Lake disputes neither proposition in this complaint because it has not yet answered. Whether Calder's belief and conduct satisfy § 3730(h) are merits questions reserved for proof.

Internal Reports

Calder alleges that she made written reports on June 4 and June 18, 2025, followed by a compliance interview on June 27. She says each report identified a category of billing exceptions, explained why ordinary reconciliation did not resolve the pattern, and requested review by personnel outside the affected reporting line.

According to Calder, management acknowledged receipt and advised that outside counsel would coordinate an internal review. Calder does not quote a communication with counsel and does not allege that she attended counsel-client discussions. Her asserted knowledge concerns her own reports, ordinary business records, and later employment events.

Alleged Adverse Actions

Calder alleges that after her reports she was removed from two recurring reconciliation meetings, received a written performance notice on July 18, and was discharged on September 12, 2025. She asserts that the stated performance concerns were inconsistent with prior evaluations and closely followed her protected reports.

The complaint alleges that a Cinder Lake human-resources representative referred generally to a completed compliance review when explaining that the organization considered Calder's concerns addressed. Calder does not allege that the representative disclosed legal advice, an interview communication, counsel's mental impressions, or the contents of an investigation memorandum.

Pre-Suit Compliance Response

On August 21, 2025, Cinder Lake sent a response to a fictional federal health-program oversight office. Calder alleges that the response stated outside counsel had reviewed her federal-program billing reports and that Cinder Lake had adopted identified remedial measures. She further alleges that the letter was later provided to her before suit.

Calder contends that the letter supports an inference that her reports concerned compliance and prompted action. The complaint does not reproduce the letter, characterize any statement as legal advice, or allege that the letter quoted or summarized counsel's communications, witness communications, mental impressions, or legal analysis.

Causation Allegations

Calder alleges temporal proximity between her June reports, the July performance notice, and the September discharge. She also alleges that decision-makers knew the subject of her reports and departed from ordinary review practices. Taken together, she says those circumstances support a plausible retaliatory motive.

Calder acknowledges that Cinder Lake may offer nonretaliatory explanations. She alleges those explanations are pretextual but does not ask the Court to resolve credibility on the pleadings. Nothing here establishes whether billing was inaccurate, whether remediation was legally required, or whether any investigation conclusion was correct.

Count One — Retaliation

Calder incorporates the preceding factual allegations and alleges that she engaged in activity protected by 31 U.S.C. § 3730(h), Cinder Lake knew of that activity, it took materially adverse employment action, and the protected activity caused the action. She seeks the remedies permitted by the statute, including reinstatement or appropriate front pay, back pay, special damages, fees, and costs.

The count rests on Calder's reports and Cinder Lake's employment response. It does not place any attorney-client communication at issue, rely on counsel's advice to prove an element, or waive protection held by Cinder Lake.

Prayer, Jury Demand, and Signature

Calder asks for judgment on Count One, lawful equitable and monetary relief, pre- and postjudgment interest where allowed, reasonable attorney's fees and costs, and any further relief the Court deems just. She demands a jury trial on all issues so triable.

Submitted December 3, 2025 by **Nina Ashe**, fictional counsel for Rhea Calder. Ashe certifies that this exercise pleading was served through the ordinary synthetic civil-filing channel on counsel designated for Cinder Lake. The caption, docket number, parties, dates, and events are fictional.